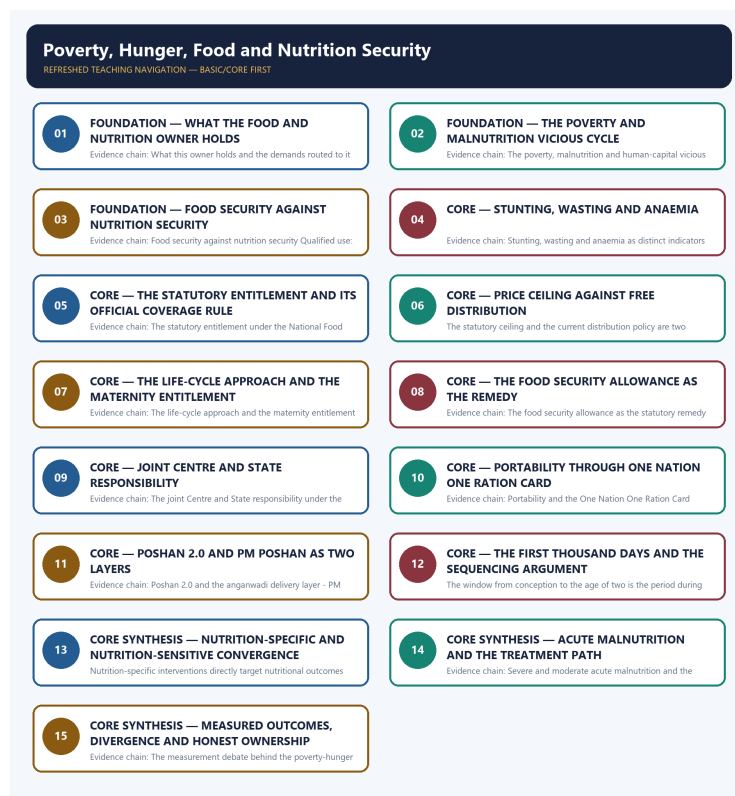


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Poverty, Hunger, Food and Nutrition Security - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Poverty, Hunger, Food and Nutrition Security - Learner-v2

Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-02. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-02.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. The OCR-searchable official General Studies question papers held under books\mains and books\more_previous_papers were read only to confirm the printed wording of routed Mains demands. No official answer key, marking scheme, page precision or unsupported quotation was imported from them.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** Three General Studies Mains demands and two objective demands are routed to this topic in the audited routing ledgers, and each Mains demand is reproduced below as a demand card with its printed year, paper, question number, directive, marks and word limit exactly as the ledgers record them: 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 17, 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 7 and 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 7. Two objective demands are also routed, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I Question 25 on the beneficiary categories and provisions of the National Food Security Act, 2013 and 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I Question 52 on the interventions and target groups of the Anaemia Mukht Bharat strategy; the audited ledger records that the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, so no option, key or inferred answer is recorded for either objective demand and neither is converted into a solved question. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm the printed wording of the routed Mains demands; no question was invented from them and no marking scheme or page precision was imported. Every model solution below is original work written to the repository's examiner-grade standard using the claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification pattern.
- **Live-link boundary:** One live official source was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's National Food Security Act portal page was read successfully on that date and states that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013 and marks a paradigm shift in the approach to food security from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system so that about two-thirds of the population is covered, that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards, that the Act is implemented in all States and Union Territories and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present with identification treated as a continuous process of excluding ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and of including births and genuine left-out households, that a guiding principle is the life-cycle approach under which pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years are entitled to a nutritious meal free of cost through anganwadi centres under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme with higher nutritional norms for malnourished children up to six years, that pregnant women and lactating mothers are further entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees, that on non-supply of entitled quantities the entitled person may receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015, and that responsibility is joint, with the Centre allocating and transporting foodgrains to designated depots and assisting delivery to the fair-price shop doorstep while States and Union Territories identify eligible households, issue ration cards and distribute entitlements. Only those statements of statutory design, coverage and responsibility are used from that page. The remaining dated elements are those already carried by the repository owners with their status checks, namely the statutory Central Issue Price ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two for wheat and one for coarse grains, the merger of the welfare grain scheme into the Act from 1 January 2023 making foodgrains free of cost to Antyodaya and priority households, the Union Cabinet extension of free distribution for five years through December 2028, the administration of Poshan 2.0 by the Ministry of

Women and Child Development and of PM POSHAN by the Ministry of Education, and the National Family Health Survey values of 35.5 per cent under-five stunting, 19.3 per cent wasting and 67.1 per cent child anaemia in the fifth round of 2019-21 against 29.3 per cent under-five stunting in the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026 and covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households. Every one of those values is round-specific or policy-date-specific and is cited here with that status, and the package states expressly that rounds must never be merged and that a portability transaction count is not asserted because it rises continuously. No poverty headcount, no multidimensional poverty value, no Periodic Labour Force Survey or National Sample Survey figure, no NITI Aayog or Sustainable Development Goal score, no budget or subsidy number, no scheme eligibility rule beyond the Act's own recorded coverage rule and no official answer key is asserted or inferred anywhere in this package.

- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Social Justice Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Legal-status boundary	Constitutional value/right, statute, rule, judgment, executive policy, scheme, eligibility rule, implementation and outcome remain distinct.
Rights-holder map	Rights-holder -> entitlement/need -> competent institution/duty-bearer -> accountability forum -> grievance/appeal/remedy.
Delivery chain	Identification -> eligibility -> documentation -> enrolment -> finance -> frontline access -> service/benefit -> portability -> outcome -> audit and correction.
Inclusion method	Intersectional caste, tribe, gender, age, disability, religion, occupation, migration and regional variation is retained without homogenising groups.
Evidence method	Claim -> named India-centric law/institution/scheme/case/dataset -> analysis -> source, reference period, release date, denominator, status and causal qualification.
Dignity and safeguards	Accessibility, privacy, participation, social audit, portability, offline access, due process and protection from stigma or coercion are tested.
Practice contract	Every model has demand decoding, detailed examiner-grade answer, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

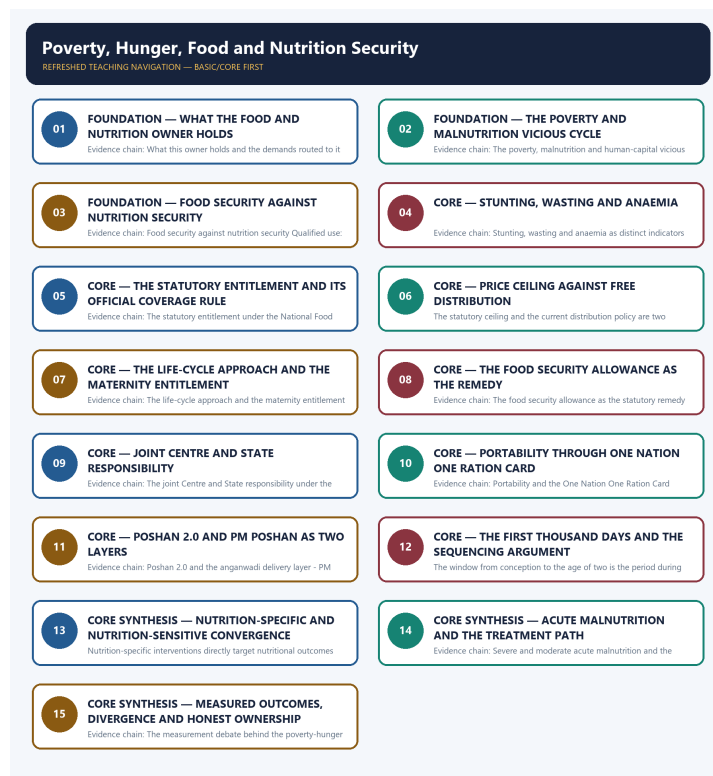
Canonical Basic/Core owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Social-Justice\basic\02_Poverty-Hunger-Food-and-Nutrition-Security.md **Substantive canonical provenance owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Social-Justice\02_Poverty-Hunger-Food-and-Nutrition-Security_Learner-V2-Complete-Topic-Package.md **Optional Advanced owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Social-Justice\advanced\02_Poverty-Hunger-Food-and-Nutrition-Security.md **Official syllabus mapping:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Social-Justice\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- **Prohibition/outcome discipline:** a legal prohibition, reported case, registration, conviction, rehabilitation measure and lived eradication are different claims.
- **Eligibility discipline:** universal, categorical, means-tested, self-declared, notified-list and residence-linked routes require exact scope; coverage never proves adequacy or access.
- **Reservation discipline:** constitutional basis, beneficiary category, competent list, ceiling, creamy-layer rule, EWS route, horizontal/vertical operation and judicial status are qualified separately.
- **Fiscal discipline:** allocation, release, expenditure, unit cost, beneficiary transfer and outcome are not interchangeable.
- **Data discipline:** retain numerator, denominator, unit, geography, reference period, release date, provisional/final status and survey-versus-administrative character.
- **Causal discipline:** headline change, before-after sequence or cross-state correlation does not establish scheme impact without mechanism and counterfactual limits.
- **PYQ discipline:** exact wording is preserved only when verified; routed or reconstructed demands remain labelled and no model is presented as an official UPSC answer.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-03:** volatile law, scheme, judgment, list, budget and dataset claims retain issuing authority, date and operative/interim/final status.

Generation-local live/current sources:

- <https://nfsa.gov.in/portal/nfsa-act>



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - WHAT THE FOOD AND NUTRITION OWNER HOLDS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: FOUNDATION - What the food and nutrition owner holds comprises FOUNDATION, What the food and nutrition owner holds as its core connected dimensions.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: What this owner holds and the demands routed to it Qualified use: Open a food or nutrition demand by naming the entitlement, the service layer and the outcome tested.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: What this owner holds and the demands routed to it Qualified use: Open a food or nutrition demand by naming the entitlement, the service layer and the outcome tested.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- What the food
- nutrition owner holds
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- This

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define What the food, connect nutrition owner holds with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WHAT THE FOOD AND NUTRITION OWNER HOLDS

01. What this owner holds and the demands routed to it

BOUNDARY -> Procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to What the food and nutrition owner holds, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Open a food or nutrition demand by naming the entitlement, the service layer and the outcome tested.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** What this owner holds and the demands routed to it
- **Qualified use:** Open a food or nutrition demand by naming the entitlement, the service layer and the outcome tested.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - WHAT THE FOOD AND NUTRITION OWNER HOLDS

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - What the food and nutrition owner holds

|
v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · What the food · nutrition owner holds · Evidence chain · Qualified use · This

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Prelims: Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to What the food and nutrition owner holds, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: what this owner holds and the demands routed to it Qualified use.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: What this owner holds and the demands routed to it Qualified use: Open a food or nutrition demand by naming the entitlement, the service layer and the outcome tested.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - THE POVERTY AND MALNUTRITION VICIOUS CYCLE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle Qualified use: Supply the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for instead of a scheme list.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle Qualified use: Supply the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for instead of a scheme list.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **The poverty**
- **malnutrition vicious cycle**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**

- The loop

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define The poverty, connect malnutrition vicious cycle with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE POVERTY AND MALNUTRITION VICIOUS CYCLE

01. The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle

BOUNDARY -> The loop is intergenerational, so a single-scheme remedy cannot break it.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The loop is intergenerational, so a single-scheme remedy cannot break it.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The poverty and malnutrition vicious cycle, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Supply the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for instead of a scheme list.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle
- **Qualified use:** Supply the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for instead of a scheme list.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - THE POVERTY AND MALNUTRITION VICIOUS CYCLE

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - The poverty and malnutrition vicious cycle

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · The poverty · malnutrition vicious cycle · Evidence chain · Qualified use
· The loop

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The loop is intergenerational, so a single-scheme remedy cannot break it.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle Qualified use: Supply the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for instead of a scheme list.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - FOOD SECURITY AGAINST NUTRITION SECURITY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Food security against nutrition security Qualified use: Protect an answer from the commonest conflation in this topic.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Food security against nutrition security Qualified use: Protect an answer from the commonest conflation in this topic.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Food security against nutrition security
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Food security
- Food

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Food security against nutrition security, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Food security for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

FOOD SECURITY AGAINST NUTRITION SECURITY

01. Food security against nutrition security

BOUNDARY -> The distribution system can work exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The distribution system can work exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Food security against nutrition security, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Protect an answer from the commonest conflation in this topic.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Food security against nutrition security
- **Qualified use:** Protect an answer from the commonest conflation in this topic.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - FOOD SECURITY AGAINST NUTRITION SECURITY

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Food security against nutrition security

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Food security against nutrition security • Evidence chain • Qualified use
• Food security • Food

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The distribution system can work exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: food security against nutrition security Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Food security against nutrition security Qualified use:
Protect an answer from the commonest conflation in this topic.

SESSION 4 - CORE - STUNTING, WASTING AND ANAEMIA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators Qualified use: Show indicator literacy before proposing any nutrition intervention.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators Qualified use: Show indicator literacy before proposing any nutrition intervention.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Stunting
- wasting
- anaemia
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- The three indicators

How to use them: Frame the answer through Stunting; define wasting, connect anaemia with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

STUNTING, WASTING AND ANAEMIA

01. Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators

BOUNDARY -> The three indicators are not interchangeable and demand different responses.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The three indicators are not interchangeable and demand different responses.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Stunting, wasting and anaemia, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Show indicator literacy before proposing any nutrition intervention.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators
- **Qualified use:** Show indicator literacy before proposing any nutrition intervention.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - STUNTING, WASTING AND ANAEMIA

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Stunting, wasting and anaemia

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Stunting · wasting · anaemia · Evidence chain · Qualified use · The three indicators

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The three indicators are not interchangeable and demand different responses.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: show indicator literacy before proposing any nutrition intervention.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators
Qualified use: Show indicator literacy before proposing any nutrition intervention.

SESSION 5 - CORE - THE STATUTORY ENTITLEMENT AND ITS OFFICIAL COVERAGE RULE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013
Qualified use: Cite the statutory entitlement with its official coverage discipline attached.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013
Qualified use: Cite the statutory entitlement with its official coverage discipline attached.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **The statutory entitlement**
- **its official coverage rule**

- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- The National Food Security Act
- Antyodaya Anna Yojana

How to use them: Frame the answer through The statutory entitlement; define its official coverage rule, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use The National Food Security Act for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE STATUTORY ENTITLEMENT AND ITS OFFICIAL COVERAGE RULE

01. The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013

BOUNDARY -> Coverage is up to seventy-five per cent rural and fifty per cent urban, not universal.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Coverage is up to seventy-five per cent rural and fifty per cent urban, not universal.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The statutory entitlement and its official coverage rule, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Cite the statutory entitlement with its official coverage discipline attached.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013
- **Qualified use:** Cite the statutory entitlement with its official coverage discipline attached.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE STATUTORY ENTITLEMENT AND ITS OFFICIAL COVERAGE RULE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The statutory entitlement and its official coverage rule

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The statutory entitlement · its official coverage rule · Evidence chain · Qualified use · The National Food Security Act · Antyodaya Anna Yojana

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Coverage is up to seventy-five per cent rural and fifty per cent urban, not universal.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013 Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013 Qualified use: Cite the statutory entitlement with its official coverage discipline attached.

SESSION 6 - CORE - PRICE CEILING AGAINST FREE DISTRIBUTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic.

Technical definition: The statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Price ceiling against free distribution
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- The Act
- Central Issue Prices
- Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna

How to use them: Frame the answer through Price ceiling against free distribution; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with The Act to explain the mechanism, and use Central Issue Prices for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

PRICE CEILING AGAINST FREE DISTRIBUTION

01. Central Issue Price ceiling against the free-distribution policy

BOUNDARY -> The statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Price ceiling against free distribution, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Avoid the single commonest factual error in this topic.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Central Issue Price ceiling against the free-distribution policy
- **Qualified use:** Avoid the single commonest factual error in this topic.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - PRICE CEILING AGAINST FREE DISTRIBUTION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Price ceiling against free distribution

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Price ceiling against free distribution · Evidence chain · Qualified use · The Act · Central Issue Prices · Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Central Issue Price ceiling against the free-distribution policy
Qualified use: Avoid the single commonest factual error in this topic.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic.

SESSION 7 - CORE - THE LIFE-CYCLE APPROACH AND THE MATERNITY ENTITLEMENT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The nutritious meal and the maternity benefit are provisions of the Act, not add-on schemes.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act
Qualified use: Argue the rights-based turn using the Act's own life-cycle clauses.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act
Qualified use: Argue the rights-based turn using the Act's own life-cycle clauses.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The life-cycle approach
- the maternity entitlement
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- The Department
- Food

How to use them: Frame the answer through The life-cycle approach; define the maternity entitlement, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use The Department for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE LIFE-CYCLE APPROACH AND THE MATERNITY ENTITLEMENT

01. The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act

BOUNDARY -> The nutritious meal and the maternity benefit are provisions of the Act, not add-on schemes.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The nutritious meal and the maternity benefit are provisions of the Act, not add-on schemes.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Argue the rights-based turn using the Act's own life-cycle clauses.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act
- **Qualified use:** Argue the rights-based turn using the Act's own life-cycle clauses.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE LIFE-CYCLE APPROACH AND THE MATERNITY ENTITLEMENT

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement

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EXACT TERMS: The life-cycle approach · the maternity entitlement · Evidence chain · Qualified use ·
The Department · Food

|

∨

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.

|

∨

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The nutritious meal and the maternity benefit are provisions of the Act, not add-on schemes.

|

∨

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act Qualified use.

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∨

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act Qualified use: Argue the rights-based turn using the Act's own life-cycle clauses.

SESSION 8 - CORE - THE FOOD SECURITY ALLOWANCE AS THE REMEDY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A right without a remedy is a scheme; the allowance rules supply the remedy.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The food security allowance as the statutory remedy Qualified use: Evidence the charity-to-claim shift instead of asserting it.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The food security allowance as the remedy
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Central Government
- Food Security Allowance Rules
- A right without a remedy

How to use them: Frame the answer through The food security allowance as the remedy; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Central Government to explain the mechanism, and use Food Security Allowance Rules for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE FOOD SECURITY ALLOWANCE AS THE REMEDY

01. The food security allowance as the statutory remedy

BOUNDARY -> A right without a remedy is a scheme; the allowance rules supply the remedy.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- A right without a remedy is a scheme; the allowance rules supply the remedy.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The food security allowance as the remedy, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Evidence the charity-to-claim shift instead of asserting it.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The food security allowance as the statutory remedy
- **Qualified use:** Evidence the charity-to-claim shift instead of asserting it.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE FOOD SECURITY ALLOWANCE AS THE REMEDY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The food security allowance as the remedy

|
v

EXACT TERMS: The food security allowance as the remedy · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Central Government · Food Security Allowance Rules · A right without a remedy

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: The food security allowance as the statutory remedy Qualified use: Evidence the charity-to-claim shift instead of asserting it.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A right without a remedy is a scheme; the allowance rules supply the remedy.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are...

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

SESSION 9 - CORE - JOINT CENTRE AND STATE RESPONSIBILITY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act Qualified use: Locate accountability precisely in a delivery-failure answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Joint Centre
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Act
- Centre
- States

How to use them: Frame the answer through Joint Centre; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Act to explain the mechanism, and use Centre for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

JOINT CENTRE AND STATE RESPONSIBILITY

01. The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act

BOUNDARY -> A delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to government in general.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- A delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to government in general.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Joint Centre and State responsibility, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Locate accountability precisely in a delivery-failure answer.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act
- **Qualified use:** Locate accountability precisely in a delivery-failure answer.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - JOINT CENTRE AND STATE RESPONSIBILITY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Joint Centre and State responsibility

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Joint Centre · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Act · Centre · States

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act
Qualified use: Locate accountability precisely in a delivery-failure answer.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to government in general.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

SESSION 10 - CORE - PORTABILITY THROUGH ONE NATION ONE RATION CARD

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism Qualified use: Link migrant inclusion to a named mechanism with its claim limit.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Portability through One Nation One Ration Card
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- One Nation One Ration Card
- Act's
- States

How to use them: Frame the answer through Portability through One Nation One Ration Card; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with One Nation One Ration Card to explain the mechanism, and use Act's for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

PORTABILITY THROUGH ONE NATION ONE RATION CARD

01. Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism

BOUNDARY -> It is an interoperability feature, not a separate card or entitlement, and its transaction count is not fixed.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- It is an interoperability feature, not a separate card or entitlement, and its transaction count is not fixed.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Portability through One Nation One Ration Card, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Link migrant inclusion to a named mechanism with its claim limit.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism
- **Qualified use:** Link migrant inclusion to a named mechanism with its claim limit.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - PORTABILITY THROUGH ONE NATION ONE RATION CARD

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Portability through One Nation One Ration Card

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Portability through One Nation One Ration Card · Evidence chain · Qualified use · One Nation One Ration Card · Act's · States

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism
Qualified use: Link migrant inclusion to a named mechanism with its claim limit.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: It is an interoperability feature, not a separate card or entitlement, and its transaction count is not fixed.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: one Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using...

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

SESSION 11 - CORE - POSHAN 2.0 AND PM POSHAN AS TWO LAYERS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer - PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer
Qualified use: Show the age-wise division of the nutrition service architecture.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer - PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer
Qualified use: Show the age-wise division of the nutrition service architecture.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Poshan 2.0**
- **PM POSHAN as two layers**

- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi,
- Poshan

How to use them: Frame the answer through Poshan 2.0; define PM POSHAN as two layers, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

POSHAN 2.0 AND PM POSHAN AS TWO LAYERS

01. Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer

|

v

02. PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer

BOUNDARY -> The ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.
- PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Poshan 2.0 and PM POSHAN as two layers, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Show the age-wise division of the nutrition service architecture.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer -> PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer

- **Qualified use:** Show the age-wise division of the nutrition service architecture.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - POSHAN 2.0 AND PM POSHAN AS TWO LAYERS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Poshan 2.0 and PM POSHAN as two layers

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Poshan 2.0 • PM POSHAN as two layers • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, • Poshan

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mains: Show the age-wise division of the nutrition service architecture.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer - PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer Qualified use: Show the age-wise division of the nutrition service architecture.

SESSION 12 - CORE - THE FIRST THOUSAND DAYS AND THE SEQUENCING ARGUMENT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: The first thousand days as the critical window Qualified use: Explain why maternal and adolescent nutrition are child-nutrition instruments.

Technical definition: The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: The first thousand days as the critical window Qualified use: Explain why maternal and adolescent nutrition are child-nutrition instruments.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **The first thousand days**
- **the sequencing argument**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Qualified**

How to use them: Frame the answer through The first thousand days; define the sequencing argument, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE FIRST THOUSAND DAYS AND THE SEQUENCING ARGUMENT

01. The first thousand days as the critical window

BOUNDARY -> Deprivation inside the window causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Deprivation inside the window causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The first thousand days and the sequencing argument, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Explain why maternal and adolescent nutrition are child-nutrition instruments.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The first thousand days as the critical window
- **Qualified use:** Explain why maternal and adolescent nutrition are child-nutrition instruments.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE FIRST THOUSAND DAYS AND THE SEQUENCING ARGUMENT

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The first thousand days and the sequencing argument

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The first thousand days • the sequencing argument • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mains: Explain why maternal and adolescent nutrition are child-nutrition instruments.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the first thousand days as the critical window Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: The first thousand days as the critical window Qualified use: Explain why maternal and adolescent nutrition are child-nutrition instruments.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - NUTRITION-SPECIFIC AND NUTRITION-SENSITIVE CONVERGENCE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions - Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal Qualified use: Build the convergence argument on a stated distinction rather than a slogan.

Technical definition: Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **Nutrition-specific**
- **nutrition-sensitive convergence**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **A take-home ration**

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Nutrition-specific, connect nutrition-sensitive convergence with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

NUTRITION-SPECIFIC AND NUTRITION-SENSITIVE CONVERGENCE

01. Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions

|
v

02. Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal

BOUNDARY -> Stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.
- A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Nutrition-specific and nutrition-sensitive convergence, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Build the convergence argument on a stated distinction rather than a slogan.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions -> Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal
- **Qualified use:** Build the convergence argument on a stated distinction rather than a slogan.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - NUTRITION-SPECIFIC AND NUTRITION-SENSITIVE CONVERGENCE

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Nutrition-specific and nutrition-sensitive convergence

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Nutrition-specific · nutrition-sensitive convergence · Evidence chain
· Qualified use · A take-home ration

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions -
Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal Qualified use: Build the convergence argument on a
stated distinction rather than a slogan.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home
and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years,
whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal
guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure,
while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming
this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Mains: Build the convergence argument on a stated distinction rather than a
slogan.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes
through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding
promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through
other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social
protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a
Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot
be procured from the food ministry alone.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - ACUTE MALNUTRITION AND THE TREATMENT PATH

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path - Measured outcomes with their survey round attached Qualified use: Answer a clinical-nutrition demand at the level of the treatment path.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path - Measured outcomes with their survey round attached Qualified use: Answer a clinical-nutrition demand at the level of the treatment path.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Acute malnutrition
- the treatment path
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- 2019-21

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Acute malnutrition, connect the treatment path with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

ACUTE MALNUTRITION AND THE TREATMENT PATH

01. Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path

|
v

02. Measured outcomes with their survey round attached

BOUNDARY -> Acute malnutrition needs screening, referral and therapeutic care, not extra grain.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.
- The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Acute malnutrition needs screening, referral and therapeutic care, not extra grain.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Acute malnutrition and the treatment path, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Answer a clinical-nutrition demand at the level of the treatment path.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path -> Measured outcomes with their survey round attached
- **Qualified use:** Answer a clinical-nutrition demand at the level of the treatment path.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - ACUTE MALNUTRITION AND THE TREATMENT PATH

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Acute malnutrition and the treatment path

|

↓

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Acute malnutrition · the treatment path · Evidence chain · Qualified use · 2019-21

|

↓

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.

|

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

|

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path - Measured outcomes with their...

|

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path - Measured outcomes with their survey round attached Qualified use: Answer a clinical-nutrition demand at the level of the treatment path.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - MEASURED OUTCOMES, DIVERGENCE AND HONEST OWNERSHIP

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence - The intervention bank for breaking the cycle - Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership Qualified use: Close with dated evidence, the measurement debate and an explicit data boundary.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence - The intervention bank for breaking the cycle - Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership Qualified use: Close with dated evidence, the measurement debate and an explicit data boundary.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Measured outcomes
- divergence
- honest ownership
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Measured outcomes, connect divergence with honest ownership to explain the mechanism, and use Evidence chain for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

MEASURED OUTCOMES, DIVERGENCE AND HONEST OWNERSHIP

01. The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence

|

v

02. The intervention bank for breaking the cycle

|

v

03. Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership

BOUNDARY -> Rounds must never be combined, and no official key is inferred for a routed objective demand.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.
- The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.
- Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists,

which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Rounds must never be combined, and no official key is inferred for a routed objective demand.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Measured outcomes, divergence and honest ownership, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Close with dated evidence, the measurement debate and an explicit data boundary.

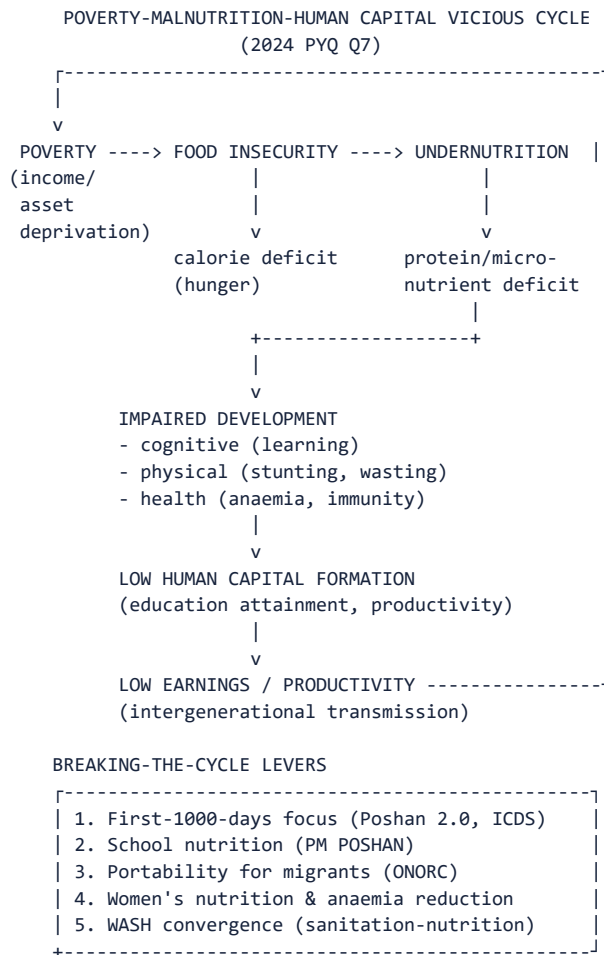
MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence -> The intervention bank for breaking the cycle -> Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership
- **Qualified use:** Close with dated evidence, the measurement debate and an explicit data boundary.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Social Justice | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-II; GS-III (food security economics), GS-I (population/poverty geography). **Core area:** NFSA entitlements; ICDS/Poshan 2.0; PM POSHAN; ONORC portability; food security vs nutrition security; stunting, wasting, anaemia. **Grounded in:** National Food Security Act, 2013; Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana merger with NFSA (free foodgrains from 1 Jan 2023, extended to Dec 2028); ICDS/Saksham Anganwadi/Poshan 2.0 (MWCD); PM POSHAN (Ministry of Education); NFHS-6 (2023-24), released on 29 May 2026, with NFHS-5 as a dated comparator; 2024 GS-II PYQ Q7. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* advanced/02_Poverty-Hunger-Food-and-Nutrition-Security.md.

1. Visual foundation



Core proposition: FACT: The poverty-malnutrition-human-capital vicious cycle (2024 PYQ Q7) traps households across generations; breaking it requires multi-sectoral intervention - food entitlements (NFSA), nutrition services (Poshan 2.0, PM POSHAN), portability (ONORC), women's anaemia focus and WASH convergence - not PDS reform alone.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Food security	Reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs - the NFSA 2013 primarily addresses calorie/grain access through statutory foodgrain entitlements (currently distributed free of cost).
FACT: Nutrition security	Goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health/sanitation environment - multi-sectoral, not just PDS.
FACT: Stunting (chronic undernutrition)	Low height-for-age in children under 5; reflects cumulative nutritional and health deprivation (especially first 1000 days) - a chronic indicator.
FACT: Wasting (acute undernutrition)	Low weight-for-height in children under 5; reflects recent/acute food shortage or illness - a crisis indicator.
FACT: Anaemia	Haemoglobin deficiency (iron, folate, B12) affecting oxygen-carrying capacity; prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women - linked to productivity and maternal/child health outcomes.
FACT: NFSA, 2013	The National Food Security Act, 2013, providing statutory entitlement to foodgrains: 5 kg/person/month for priority households, 35 kg/household/month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana (AAY) households. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of Rs 3/kg rice, Rs 2/kg wheat and Rs 1/kg coarse grains - but since 1 January 2023 the PM Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana (PMGKAY) has been merged with the NFSA and all NFSA foodgrains are distributed free of cost to AAY/priority-household beneficiaries; the Union Cabinet extended this free-foodgrain policy for five years, through December 2028. Current policy is free distribution, not the Rs 1-3/kg statutory ceiling.
FACT: ONORC	One Nation One Ration Card - enables portability of NFSA entitlements across states using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and ePoS (electronic Point of Sale) machines; critical for migrant/mobile beneficiaries.
FACT: Poshan 2.0 / Saksham Anganwadi	The umbrella nutrition programme (MWCD) merging ICDS and related schemes; delivers supplementary nutrition, growth monitoring, pre-school education and referral through anganwadi centres; emphasises first-1000-days (conception to age 2) intervention.
FACT: PM POSHAN (erstwhile Mid-Day Meal)	The school-nutrition programme (Ministry of Education) providing cooked meals to children in government/aided schools (Classes I-VIII); objectives include attendance, retention and nutritional status improvement.

3. How the food-and-nutrition-security mechanism works

- NFSA entitlement architecture:** Coverage via priority households (~75% rural, ~50% urban) and AAY (poorest of poor); foodgrain entitlement per person per month; the Act's statutory Central Issue Price ceiling (Rs 3/kg rice, Rs 2/kg wheat, Rs 1/kg coarse grains) has been superseded in practice by free distribution since 1 January 2023 (PMGKAY-NFSA merger, extended to December 2028) - but NFSA addresses calorie access, not dietary diversity.
- Poshan 2.0 / ICDS delivery:** Anganwadi centres provide supplementary nutrition (take-home ration, hot cooked meals), growth monitoring (weight/height tracking), pre-school education, immunisation referral and health/nutrition counselling - primary focus is children under 6, pregnant and lactating women.
- PM POSHAN (school nutrition):** Cooked mid-day meal in schools addresses

immediate hunger, improves attendance and provides a platform for nutrition education - complements ICDS for school-age children.

4. **ONORC portability:** Aadhaar-seeded ration cards allow beneficiaries to draw entitlements from any ePoS-enabled fair-price shop nationwide - addresses migrant exclusion from state-specific PDS lists.

5. **WASH convergence:** Sanitation (SBM), safe water (JJM) and hygiene behaviour affect nutrient absorption; stunting reduction requires convergence beyond food alone.

4. Institutions and tools

- FACT: **NFSA, 2013:** Statutory entitlement; administered by Department of Food and Public Distribution (MoCAFPD) at Union level, state food/civil supplies departments at state level.
- FACT: **Poshan 2.0 / Saksham Anganwadi:** Administered by Ministry of Women and Child Development (MWCD); implemented through ICDS infrastructure (anganwadi centres, AWWs/helpers).
- FACT: **PM POSHAN:** Administered by Ministry of Education; implemented through state education departments and school management committees.
- FACT: **ONORC:** Technical backbone provided by NIC/FCI; requires Aadhaar seeding, ePoS rollout and inter-state data sharing.
- FACT: **NFHS (National Family Health Survey):** Primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes. NFHS-6 (2023-24), released on 29 May 2026, is the current national round; retain the round beside every value.

5. Indian applications and examples

- FACT: **2024 GS-II PYQ Q7 (10 marks, 150 words):** "Poverty and malnutrition create a vicious cycle, adversely affecting human capital formation. What steps can be taken to break the cycle?" - the expected answer traces the intergenerational trap and lists multi-sectoral levers (Poshan 2.0/first-1000-days, PM POSHAN, ONORC, women's anaemia, WASH convergence).
- ANALYSIS: ONORC enabled migrant workers during COVID-19 lockdowns to access rations outside their home states - illustrates the portability rationale.
- FACT: **NFHS-5 (2019-21) baseline:** 35.5% of children under five were stunted, 19.3% were wasted and 67.1% of children aged 6-59 months were anaemic nationally. These are a dated baseline, not a current dashboard total.
- FACT: **NFHS-6 (2023-24) current anchor:** under-five stunting was reported at 29.3%; the survey covered 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households. Do not combine NFHS-5 and NFHS-6 indicators without naming each round.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: NFSA, 2013 provides 5 kg/person/month for priority households and 35 kg/household/month for AAY households; the Act's statutory Central Issue Price ceiling is Rs 3/kg rice, Rs 2/kg wheat and Rs 1/kg coarse grains, but foodgrains have been distributed **free of cost** to NFSA beneficiaries since 1 January 2023 (PMGKAY-NFSA merger), extended through December 2028.
- FACT: Stunting = height-for-age (chronic); wasting = weight-for-height (acute).
- FACT: Poshan 2.0 is administered by MWCD; PM POSHAN is administered by Ministry of Education.
- FACT: ONORC enables inter-state portability of NFSA entitlements using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and ePoS.
- FACT: First-1000-days (conception to age 2) is the critical window for preventing stunting and cognitive impairment.

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: NFSA addresses nutrition security comprehensively. -> NFSA primarily addresses calorie/grain access (food security); nutrition security requires dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and WASH - a multi-sectoral effort beyond PDS.
- WRONG: Stunting and wasting are interchangeable terms. -> Stunting (height-for-age) reflects chronic deprivation; wasting (weight-for-height) reflects acute deprivation - different indicators, different policy responses.
- WRONG: PM POSHAN is administered by MWCD. -> PM POSHAN (erstwhile Mid-Day Meal) is administered by the Ministry of Education; Poshan 2.0/ICDS is administered by MWCD.
- WRONG: ONORC is a separate ration card. -> ONORC is a portability mechanism enabling existing NFSA beneficiaries to draw entitlements anywhere; it is not a separate card but a system interoperability feature.
- WRONG: NFSA beneficiaries currently pay Rs 1-3/kg for their foodgrain entitlement. -> Rs 3/kg rice, Rs 2/kg wheat and Rs 1/kg coarse grains is the Act's statutory Central Issue Price ceiling, not current practice; foodgrains have been provided free of cost to AAY/priority-household beneficiaries since 1 January 2023, a policy the Union Cabinet extended through December 2028.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- CURRENT: **Survey-status check (29 May 2026):** NFHS-6 (2023-24) is released. Its under-five stunting estimate is 29.3%, compared with 35.5% in NFHS-5. Retain the reporting round and do not mix survey rounds.
- CURRENT: **Free-foodgrain policy:** NFSA foodgrains have been distributed free of cost to AAY/priority-household beneficiaries since 1 January 2023 (PMGKAY merged into NFSA), and the Union Cabinet extended this free-distribution policy for five years, through December 2028, covering roughly 81 crore beneficiaries.
- CURRENT: ONORC portability transactions can be tracked on the IMPDS portal; the cumulative transaction count rises continuously and is not fixed here - the durable fact is the system's operational inter-state portability.

9. PYQ application

- FACT: **2024 Q7 (10 marks):** Structure the answer as:
 1. Define the vicious cycle (poverty -> undernutrition -> impaired development -> low productivity -> poverty).
 2. Identify the intergenerational trap (stunted child -> lower-earning adult -> malnourished offspring).
 3. List breaking-the-cycle levers: (a) Poshan 2.0 / first-1000-days focus, (b) PM POSHAN for school-age nutrition, (c) ONORC portability for migrants, (d) women's nutrition and anaemia reduction (adolescent girls, PLW), (e) WASH convergence (sanitation-nutrition link).
 4. Conclude with the multi-sectoral, convergence imperative.
- FACT: **2025 GS-II Q16 (15 marks, 250 words):** "Inequality in the ownership pattern of resources is one of the major causes of poverty. Discuss in the context of 'paradox of poverty'." Use the loop: unequal land/assets/credit/digital access -> unequal opportunity and bargaining power -> low capability/income -> weak saving and asset formation -> inherited inequality. A critical-comment answer should test this explanation against joblessness, unequal public-service access and implementation failures, then distinguish redistribution of productive assets from consumption relief.

10. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Use the vicious-cycle diagram as the default framing for any poverty-nutrition question - it directly maps to 2024 Q7.

- ANALYSIS: Distinguish food security (calorie access via NFSA) from nutrition security (dietary diversity, micronutrients, WASH) - a recurring exam distinction.
- ANALYSIS: Emphasise the first-1000-days window: interventions during pregnancy and the first two years yield the highest returns in preventing stunting.
- ANALYSIS: Link ONORC to migrant-worker inclusion - a current-affairs-friendly angle.

Answer thesis: The poverty-malnutrition-human-capital vicious cycle is intergenerational and multi-causal; breaking it requires not only food entitlements (NFSA) but also nutrition services focused on the first 1000 days (Poshan 2.0), school nutrition (PM POSHAN), portability for migrants (ONORC), women's anaemia reduction and WASH convergence - a single-scheme approach is structurally insufficient.

11. Probable questions

- FACT: **Mains (10 marks, 2024 Q7):** Poverty and malnutrition create a vicious cycle, adversely affecting human capital formation. What steps can be taken to break the cycle?
- FACT: **Mains (15 marks, 2025 GS-II Q16):** "Inequality in the ownership pattern of resources is one of the major causes of poverty. Discuss in the context of 'paradox of poverty'."
- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Which scheme enables inter-state portability of NFSA entitlements using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards - ONORC, PM POSHAN, Poshan 2.0 or NFHS?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** "Food security is necessary but not sufficient for nutrition security." Discuss with reference to India's policy architecture.

11A. Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

Direct Mains demands owned by Core

- **2018 GS-II:** food availability versus human-development causes of hunger.
- **2019 GS-II:** divergence between poverty reduction and hunger. These Core routes supersede the older advanced/02 pointers.

Evidence and argument bank

- **Lifecycle nutrition:** adolescent girls -> pregnancy and first 1,000 days -> breastfeeding/complementary feeding -> preschool services -> PM POSHAN.
- **SAM/MAM:** severe and moderate acute malnutrition require screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up; foodgrain allocation is insufficient.
- **THR versus hot meals:** Take-Home Rations support household feeding for pregnancy, lactation and young children; supervised hot meals support anganwadi/school consumption.
- **Anaemia Mukht Bharat:** use the 6x6x6 strategy as a multi-cause intervention bank.
- **Fortification:** can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.
- **Measurement:** income/calorie poverty, MPI and anthropometry measure different deprivations; falling monetary poverty can coexist with hunger.

10 marks: vicious cycle plus 2-3 named interventions. **15 marks:** separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation and use 4-6 evidence units. **20 marks:** add measurement debate, fiscal priorities, gender/WASH/health convergence and a graded universal-versus-targeted judgment.

Reasoned verdict: Food entitlement is necessary, but hunger ends only when it is converted into diverse diets, maternal-child care, disease control and accountable local delivery.

12. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion: [advanced/02_Poverty-Hunger-Food-and-Nutrition-Security.md](#).

- FACT: Economy/basic/12_MSP-Procurement-Buffer-Stocks-PDS-and-Food-Security.md - procurement/buffer-stock mechanics (Economy owns this; Social Justice applies entitlement access).
- FACT: Economy/basic/23_Poverty-Inequality-Social-Sector-and-Inclusive-Growth.md - macro poverty/inequality measurement (Economy owns MPI detail).
- FACT: 01_Social-Justice-Concept-Inclusion-and-Welfare-State-Framework.md - the capability approach: food and nutrition inputs must convert into health and cognitive capability.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-II	7	Poverty-malnutrition vicious cycle and human-capital formation	Explain · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Poverty-malnutrition vicious cycle and human-capital formation

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	17	Food availability focus against human development policies as cause of hunger	How far do you agree · 15 marks · 250 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2018	Prelims GS-I	25	National Food Security Act 2013 beneficiary categories and provisions	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	GS-II	7	Divergence between poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure	Elucidate · 10 marks · 150 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	Prelims GS-I	52	Anaemia Mukht Bharat Strategy interventions and target groups	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Food availability focus against human development policies as cause of hunger
- National Food Security Act 2013 beneficiary categories and provisions
- Divergence between poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure
- Anaemia Mukht Bharat Strategy interventions and target groups

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - MEASURED OUTCOMES, DIVERGENCE AND HONEST OWNERSHIP

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Measured outcomes, divergence and honest ownership

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Measured outcomes · divergence · honest ownership · Evidence chain · Qualified use

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: What steps can be taken to break the cycle? FACT: Mains (15 marks, 2025 GS-II Q16): "Inequality in the ownership pattern of resources is one of the major causes of poverty.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: These are a dated baseline, not a current dashboard total. FACT: NFHS-6 (2023-24) current anchor: under-five stunting was reported at 29.3%; the survey covered 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not combine NFHS-5 and NFHS-6 indicators without naming each round.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence - The intervention bank for breaking the cycle - Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership Qualified use: Close with dated evidence, the measurement debate and an explicit data boundary.

SOCIAL JUSTICE DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** Poverty, hunger, food insecurity, undernutrition and malnutrition overlap but use different concepts, indicators and denominators; deprivation is produced through income, assets, prices, care, disease, sanitation, discrimination and public-service access.
- **Close distinction:** Poverty incidence is not depth, food availability is not household access, calorie adequacy is not diet quality, stunting is not wasting, NFSA entitlement is not universal nutrition security, and scheme coverage is not nutritional outcome.
- **Authority / evidence / implementation limit:** Use NFSA, PDS/ONORC, ICDS/Saksham Anganwadi, PM POSHAN, POSHAN evidence and MPI/NFHS data with source, reference period and denominator; trace eligibility, documentation, portability, exclusion, grievance and convergence without inferring causality from headline statistics.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this owner holds and the demands routed to it?

A. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. B. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. C. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. D. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: A. Explanation: This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under What this owner holds and the demands routed to it?

A. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. B. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. C. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. D. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: B. Explanation: This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this owner holds and the demands routed to it?

A. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. B. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement,

buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. D. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Answer: C. Explanation: This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this owner holds and the demands routed to it?

A. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. B. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. C. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. D. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion.

Answer: D. Explanation: This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of

procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle?

A. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. B. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. C. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Answer: A. Explanation: The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle?

A. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. B. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. C. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low

weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Answer: B. Explanation: The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle?

A. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. B. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. C. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. D. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic.

Answer: C. Explanation: The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from

impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle?

A. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. B. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. C. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. D. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for.

Answer: D. Explanation: The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Food security against nutrition security?

A. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. B. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons

are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. C. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic.

Answer: A. Explanation: Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Food security against nutrition security?

A. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. B. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. C. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. D. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.

Answer: B. Explanation: Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity,

micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Food security against nutrition security?

A. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. B. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. C. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. D. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

Answer: C. Explanation: Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Food security against nutrition security?

A. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. B. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. C. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026,

records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. D. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

Answer: D. Explanation: Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators?

A. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. B. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. C. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. D. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Answer: A. Explanation: Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and

anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators?

A. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. B. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. D. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.

Answer: B. Explanation: Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators?

A. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. B. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop,

while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. C. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

Answer: C. Explanation: Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators?

A. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. B. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. C. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. D. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: D. Explanation: Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic

one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013?

A. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. B. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. C. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. D. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013?

A. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. B. The National Food

Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. C. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. D. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013?

A. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. B. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. C. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national

informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013?

A. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. B. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. C. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. D. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Central Issue Price ceiling against the free-distribution policy?

A. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. B. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. C. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. D. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Central Issue Price ceiling against the free-distribution policy?

A. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. B. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. C. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated

Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Central Issue Price ceiling against the free-distribution policy?

A. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. B. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. C. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Central Issue Price ceiling against the free-distribution policy?

A. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. B. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. C. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. D. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act?

A. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. B. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. C. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person

within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. D. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act?

A. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. B. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. C. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme

and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act?

A. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. B. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. C. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. D. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act?

A. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. B. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies The food security allowance as the statutory remedy?

A. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. B. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. C. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that

addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. D. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Answer: A. Explanation: The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under The food security allowance as the statutory remedy?

A. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. B. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. C. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. D. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.

Answer: B. Explanation: The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The food security allowance as the statutory remedy?

A. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. B. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. C. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. D. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.

Answer: C. Explanation: The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The food security allowance as the statutory remedy?

A. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. B. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015;

this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

Answer: D. Explanation: The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act?

A. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. B. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. C. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. D. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Answer: A. Explanation: The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act?

A. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. B. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Answer: B. Explanation: The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act?

A. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. B. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. C. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. D. The window from

conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

Answer: C. Explanation: The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act?

A. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. B. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

Answer: D. Explanation: The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism?

A. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. B. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Answer: A. Explanation: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism?

A. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. B. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. C. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather

than duplicates. D. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

Answer: B. Explanation: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism?

A. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. B. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. C. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. D. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

Answer: C. Explanation: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism?

A. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. B. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. C. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

Answer: D. Explanation: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer?

A. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. B. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. C. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. D. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved

nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.

Answer: A. Explanation: Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer?

A. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. B. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.

Answer: B. Explanation: Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer?

A. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. B. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social

protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. C. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. D. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.

Answer: C. Explanation: Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer?

A. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. B. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. C. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. D. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Answer: D. Explanation: Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand

days from conception to age two. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer?

A. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. B. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. C. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. D. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

Answer: A. Explanation: PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer?

A. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. B. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. C. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. D. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot

cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it.

Answer: B. Explanation: PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer?

A. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. B. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. C. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. D. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

Answer: C. Explanation: PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer?

A. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. B. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. C. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. D. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.

Answer: D. Explanation: PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The first thousand days as the critical window?

A. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. B. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. C. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. D. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based

supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.

Answer: A. Explanation: The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under The first thousand days as the critical window?

A. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. B. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. C. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. D. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it.

Answer: B. Explanation: The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The first thousand days as the critical window?

A. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. B. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition

rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

Answer: C. Explanation: The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The first thousand days as the critical window?

A. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukht Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. B. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. C. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. D. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

Answer: D. Explanation: The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as

child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions?

A. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. B. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. C. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. D. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

Answer: A. Explanation: Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions?

A. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. B. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. C. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh

households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. D. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

Answer: B. Explanation: Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions?

A. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. B. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. C. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. D. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

Answer: C. Explanation: Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions?

A. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. B. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. C. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. D. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.

Answer: D. Explanation: Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal?

A. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. B. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. C. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. D. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the

primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

Answer: A. Explanation: A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal?

A. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. B. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. C. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukt Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. D. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

Answer: B. Explanation: A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal?

A. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukht Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. B. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. C. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. D. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

Answer: C. Explanation: A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal?

A. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. B. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. C. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation

One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. D. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it.

Answer: D. Explanation: A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path?

A. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. B. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. C. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. D. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

Answer: A. Explanation: Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path?

A. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. B. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. C. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. D. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.

Answer: B. Explanation: Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path?

A. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. B. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. C. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is

severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. D. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.

Answer: C. Explanation: Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path?

A. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. B. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. C. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. D. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.

Answer: D. Explanation: Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Measured outcomes with their survey round attached?

A. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. B. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. C. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukht Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. D. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Measured outcomes with their survey round attached?

A. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. B. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. C. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered

through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. D. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Measured outcomes with their survey round attached?

A. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. B. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. C. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. D. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or

policy date.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Measured outcomes with their survey round attached?

A. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. B. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. C. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. D. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence?

A. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. B. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. C. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. D. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion.

Answer: A. Explanation: Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence?

A. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. B. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. C. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings,

which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. D. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

Answer: B. Explanation: Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence?

A. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. B. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. C. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. D. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

Answer: C. Explanation: Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence?

A. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. B. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. D. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

Answer: D. Explanation: Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies The intervention bank for breaking the cycle?

A. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. B. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. C. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its

issuing body, survey round or policy date. D. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under The intervention bank for breaking the cycle?

A. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. B. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. C. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. D. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The intervention bank for breaking the cycle?

A. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. B. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. C. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. D. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The intervention bank for breaking the cycle?

A. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. B. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. C. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and

pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership?

A. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. B. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. C. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. D. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

Answer: A. Explanation: Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership?

A. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. B. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. C. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. D. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: B. Explanation: Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership?

A. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. B. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as

interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. D. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Answer: C. Explanation: Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership?

A. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. B. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. D. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for

migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

Answer: D. Explanation: Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Three General Studies Mains demands and two objective demands are routed to this topic in the audited routing ledgers, and each Mains demand is reproduced below as a demand card with its printed year, paper, question number, directive, marks and word limit exactly as the ledgers record them: 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 17, 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 7 and 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 7. Two objective demands are also routed, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I Question 25 on the beneficiary categories and provisions of the National Food Security Act, 2013 and 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I Question 52 on the interventions and target groups of the Anaemia Mukt Bharat strategy; the audited ledger records that the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, so no option, key or inferred answer is recorded for either objective demand and neither is converted into a solved question. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm the printed wording of the routed Mains demands; no question was invented from them and no marking scheme or page precision was imported. Every model solution below is original work written to the repository's examiner-grade standard using the claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification pattern.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Define the vulnerable group, deprivation, right or policy concept and distinguish the nearest legal and measured category. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Identify the constitutional, statutory, judicial or executive basis and the competent Union, state or local institution. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Map rights-holder, household/community context, duty-bearer, frontline worker, provider and accountability forum. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace identification, eligibility, documentation, finance, access, portability, grievance, appeal and correction. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Use a named Indian law, judgment, scheme, institution or official dataset with source, date, denominator and status. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test intersectionality, regional variation, stigma, accessibility, privacy, fiscal adequacy, exclusion and causal limits. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- FACT: **2024 Q7 (10 marks):** Structure the answer as:

1. Define the vicious cycle (poverty -> undernutrition -> impaired development -> low productivity -> poverty).

2. Identify the intergenerational trap (stunted child -> lower-earning adult -> malnourished offspring).

3. List breaking-the-cycle levers: (a) Poshan 2.0 / first-1000-days focus, (b) PM POSHAN for school-age nutrition, (c) ONORC portability for migrants, (d) women's nutrition and anaemia reduction (adolescent girls, PLW), (e) WASH convergence (sanitation-nutrition link).

4. Conclude with the multi-sectoral, convergence imperative.

- FACT: **2025 GS-II Q16 (15 marks, 250 words):** "Inequality in the ownership pattern of

resources is one of the major causes of poverty. Discuss in the context of 'paradox of poverty'." Use the loop: unequal land/assets/credit/digital access -> unequal opportunity and bargaining power -> low capability/income -> weak saving and asset formation -> inherited inequality. A critical-comment answer should test this explanation against joblessness, unequal public-service access and implementation failures, then distinguish redistribution of productive assets from consumption relief.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-II	7	Poverty-malnutrition vicious cycle and human-capital formation	Explain · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Poverty-malnutrition vicious cycle and human-capital formation

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	17	Food availability focus against human development policies as cause of hunger	How far do you agree · 15 marks · 250 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2018	Prelims GS-I	25	National Food Security Act 2013 beneficiary categories and provisions	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	GS-II	7	Divergence between poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure	Elucidate · 10 marks · 150 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	Prelims GS-I	52	Anaemia Mukt Bharat Strategy interventions and target groups	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Food availability focus against human development policies as cause of hunger
- National Food Security Act 2013 beneficiary categories and provisions
- Divergence between poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure
- Anaemia Mukh Bharat Strategy interventions and target groups

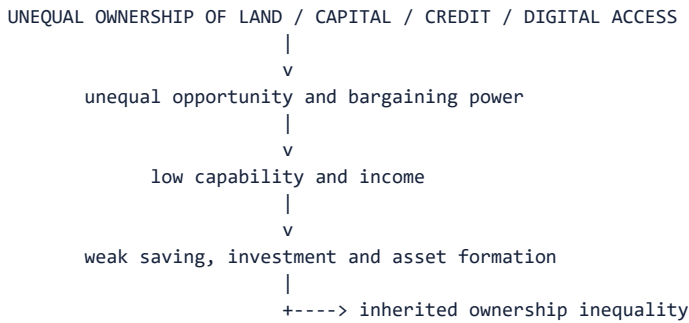
The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

3. Detailed causal chain: the intergenerational trap (2024 PYQ Q7)

1. **Poverty** limits household capacity to purchase diverse, nutrient-dense food and invest in health/sanitation.
2. **Food insecurity** manifests as calorie deficit (hunger) and dietary monotony (lack of micronutrients).
3. **Undernutrition in early childhood** (especially first 1000 days) causes stunting (chronic) and wasting (acute), impairs cognitive development and weakens immunity.
4. **Impaired development** reduces school attendance, learning outcomes and skill acquisition.
5. **Low human capital** translates into low productivity and earnings in adulthood.
6. **Low earnings** perpetuate household poverty, which is then transmitted to the next generation (intergenerational trap).
7. **Breaking-the-cycle levers:**
 - Nutrition-specific: Poshan 2.0 (first-1000-days focus), PM POSHAN (school-age), micronutrient supplementation (IFA tablets).
 - Nutrition-sensitive: WASH convergence (SBM, JJM), income support (DBT, social security), agricultural diversification.
 - Portability: ONORC for migrant-worker inclusion.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: **2024 Q7 (10 marks):** A strong answer should:
 1. Diagram the vicious cycle (poverty -> undernutrition -> impaired development -> low productivity -> poverty).
 2. Distinguish nutrition-specific (Poshan 2.0, PM POSHAN, micronutrient supplementation) from nutrition-sensitive (WASH, income support, agriculture) interventions.
 3. Emphasise the first-1000-days window and women's nutrition (anaemia in adolescent girls and PLW).
 4. Cite ONORC portability for migrant inclusion.
 5. Conclude with the convergence imperative: no single scheme breaks the cycle.
- FACT: **2025 GS-II Q16 (15 marks, 250 words):** Build the "paradox of poverty" as a self-reinforcing asset-capability loop:



Separate productive-asset reform (land records/tenancy security, credit, skills, commons and digital access) from necessary but non-transformative consumption relief.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	17	Food availability focus against human development policies as cause of hunger	How far do you agree · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	GS-II	7	Divergence between poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure	Elucidate · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic; word limit taken from the instruction block	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Food availability focus against human development policies as cause of hunger
- Divergence between poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 17

Demand: How far do you agree that a focus on the availability of food rather than on human development policies is the cause of hunger in India, 15 marks, 250 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the availability argument is partly right and structurally incomplete, because availability is only the first of four stages and hunger in India is produced mainly at the access and absorption stages. Named evidence and example: the statutory entitlement of five kilograms per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households under the National Food Security Act, 2013, with the Department of Food and Public Distribution portal read on 2 September 2026 recording enactment on 5 July 2013, coverage of up to seventy-five per cent of the rural and fifty per cent of the urban population and a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons; the Act's life-cycle provisions and the maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees; the distinction between nutrition-specific and nutrition-sensitive interventions; and the National

Family Health Survey record of under-five stunting at 35.5 per cent in the fifth round of 2019-21 and 29.3 per cent in the sixth round of 2023-24 released on 29 May 2026. Analysis: an availability-first reading explains procurement and buffer policy but cannot explain why a household holding a valid card remains undernourished, since access fails through identification, documentation and migration barriers, and absorption fails through diarrhoeal disease, unsafe water and poor sanitation, which is precisely why the reduction in stunting between two named rounds cannot be credited to grain allocation alone. Qualification: the human-development reading must not be pushed into denying that availability matters, because a chronic supply failure would make every downstream policy irrelevant, and each indicator must be carried with its survey round. Why this earns marks: it takes a position on a how-far-do-you-agree directive, uses the four-stage frame as the organising device and closes with a bounded verdict.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 17”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the availability argument is partly right and structurally incomplete, because availability is only the first of four stages and hunger in India is produced mainly at the access and absorption stages. Named evidence and example: the statutory entitlement of five kilograms per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households under the National Food Security Act, 2013, with the Department of Food and Public Distribution portal read on 2 September 2026 recording enactment on 5 July 2013, coverage of up to seventy-five per cent of the rural and fifty per cent of the urban population and a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons; the Act's life-cycle provisions and the maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees; the distinction between nutrition-specific and nutrition-sensitive interventions; and the National Family Health Survey record of under-five stunting at 35.5 per cent in the fifth round of 2019-21 and 29.3 per cent in the sixth round of 2023-24 released on 29 May 2026. Analysis: an availability-first reading explains procurement and buffer policy but cannot explain why a household holding a valid card remains undernourished, since access fails through identification, documentation and migration barriers, and absorption fails through diarrhoeal disease, unsafe water and poor sanitation, which is precisely why the reduction in stunting between two named rounds cannot be credited to grain allocation alone. Qualification: the human-development reading must not be pushed into denying that availability matters, because a chronic supply failure would make every downstream policy irrelevant, and each indicator must be carried with its survey round. Why this earns marks: it takes a position on a how-far-do-you-agree directive, uses the four-stage frame as the organising device and closes with a bounded verdict.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 17 **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the availability argument is partly right and structurally incomplete, because availability is only the first of four stages and hunger in India is produced mainly at the access and absorption stages. Named evidence and example: the statutory entitlement of five kilograms per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households under the National Food Security Act, 2013, with the Department of Food and Public Distribution portal read on 2 September 2026 recording enactment on 5 July 2013, coverage of up to seventy-five per cent of the rural and fifty per cent of the urban population and a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons; the Act's life-cycle provisions and the maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees; the distinction between nutrition-specific and nutrition-sensitive interventions; and the National Family Health Survey record of under-five stunting at 35.5 per cent in the fifth round of 2019-21 and 29.3 per cent in the sixth round of 2023-24 released on 29 May 2026. Analysis: an availability-first reading explains

procurement and buffer policy but cannot explain why a household holding a valid card remains undernourished, since access fails through identification, documentation and migration barriers, and absorption fails through diarrhoeal disease, unsafe water and poor sanitation, which is precisely why the reduction in stunting between two named rounds cannot be credited to grain allocation alone. Qualification: the human-development reading must not be pushed into denying that availability matters, because a chronic supply failure would make every downstream policy irrelevant, and each indicator must be carried with its survey round. Why this earns marks: it takes a position on a how-far-do-you-agree directive, uses the four-stage frame as the organising device and closes with a bounded verdict.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 17”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 7

Demand: Elucidate the relationship between the divergence of poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure, 10 marks, 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: poverty and hunger diverge because they are measured by different instruments and repaired by different expenditures, so a fall in one is not evidence of a fall in the other. Named evidence and example: the owner's rule that income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations; the four-stage availability, access, absorption and utilisation frame; the anganwadi service layer under Poshan 2.0 with the Ministry of Women and Child Development and the school layer under PM POSHAN with the Ministry of Education; and the first thousand days from conception to age two as the window in which deprivation becomes irreversible. Analysis: monetary poverty responds to income, transfer and employment expenditure, whereas hunger and undernutrition respond to service expenditure on anganwadi staffing, growth monitoring, therapeutic care, water and sanitation, so compressing the service head while transfers hold produces exactly the observed divergence, and because the critical window is short, a service compression today is recorded in the anthropometry of the next decade. Qualification: no expenditure figure or trend is asserted here, since budget numbers must be cited with their year and head, and the divergence claim itself must be carried with the survey rounds compared. Why this earns marks: it elucidates a mechanism connecting two measurements to two expenditure heads instead of describing poverty in general.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 7”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: poverty and hunger diverge because they are measured by different instruments and repaired by different expenditures, so a fall in one is not evidence of a fall in the other. Named evidence and example: the owner's rule that income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations; the four-stage availability, access, absorption and utilisation frame; the anganwadi service layer under Poshan 2.0 with the Ministry of Women and Child Development and the school layer under PM POSHAN with the Ministry of Education; and the first thousand days from conception to age two as the window in which deprivation becomes irreversible. Analysis: monetary poverty responds to income, transfer and employment expenditure, whereas hunger and undernutrition respond to service expenditure on anganwadi staffing, growth monitoring, therapeutic care, water and sanitation, so compressing the service head while transfers hold produces exactly the observed divergence, and because the critical window is short, a service compression today is recorded in the anthropometry of the next decade. Qualification: no expenditure figure or trend is asserted here, since budget numbers must be cited with their year and head, and the divergence claim itself must be carried with the survey rounds compared. Why this earns

marks: it elucidates a mechanism connecting two measurements to two expenditure heads instead of describing poverty in general.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 7 **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Elucidate the relationship between the divergence of poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure, 10 marks, 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: poverty and hunger diverge because they are measured by different instruments and repaired by different expenditures, so a fall in one is not evidence of a fall in the other. Named evidence and example: the owner's rule that income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations; the four-stage availability, access, absorption and utilisation frame; the anganwadi service layer under Poshan 2.0 with the Ministry of Women and Child Development and the school layer under PM POSHAN with the Ministry of Education; and the first thousand days from conception to age two as the window in which deprivation becomes irreversible. Analysis: monetary poverty responds to income, transfer and employment expenditure, whereas hunger and undernutrition respond to service expenditure on anganwadi staffing, growth monitoring, therapeutic care, water and sanitation, so compressing the service head while transfers hold produces exactly the observed divergence, and because the critical window is short, a service compression today is recorded in the anthropometry of the next decade. Qualification: no expenditure figure or trend is asserted here, since budget numbers must be cited with their year and head, and the divergence claim itself must be carried with the survey rounds compared. Why this earns marks: it elucidates a mechanism connecting two measurements to two expenditure heads instead of describing poverty in general.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 7", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 7

Demand: Poverty and malnutrition create a vicious cycle, adversely affecting human capital formation. What steps can be taken to break the cycle, explain, 10 marks, 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and reproduced in the Basic owner.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the cycle is intergenerational, so it is broken only at the points where deprivation becomes irreversible and where entitlement fails to travel with the person. Named evidence and example: the loop from income and asset deprivation through calorie and micronutrient deficit to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, low human capital and low earnings; the first thousand days from conception to age two; Poshan 2.0

and the anganwadi layer under the Ministry of Women and Child Development; PM POSHAN in Classes I to VIII under the Ministry of Education; One Nation One Ration Card portability using Aadhaar-seeded cards and electronic point-of-sale machines; and the national anaemia strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design for adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women. Analysis: the first thousand days fix the sequencing, because a stunted child becomes a lower-earning adult whose child is again undernourished, so maternal and adolescent nutrition are child-nutrition instruments rather than separate heads; portability addresses the exclusion produced by migration; and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene addresses absorption, which no additional grain allocation can reach. Qualification: acute malnutrition is not answered by extra grain, since severe acute malnutrition at weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations requires facility-based therapeutic care, and every outcome cited must carry its survey round, with under-five stunting recorded at 35.5 per cent in the fifth round of 2019-21 and 29.3 per cent in the sixth round of 2023-24. Why this earns marks: it explains a loop, attaches each lever to the exact link it cuts and ends with a treatment and data qualification.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 7”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the cycle is intergenerational, so it is broken only at the points where deprivation becomes irreversible and where entitlement fails to travel with the person. Named evidence and example: the loop from income and asset deprivation through calorie and micronutrient deficit to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, low human capital and low earnings; the first thousand days from conception to age two; Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi layer under the Ministry of Women and Child Development; PM POSHAN in Classes I to VIII under the Ministry of Education; One Nation One Ration Card portability using Aadhaar-seeded cards and electronic point-of-sale machines; and the national anaemia strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design for adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women. Analysis: the first thousand days fix the sequencing, because a stunted child becomes a lower-earning adult whose child is again undernourished, so maternal and adolescent nutrition are child-nutrition instruments rather than separate heads; portability addresses the exclusion produced by migration; and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene addresses absorption, which no additional grain allocation can reach. Qualification: acute malnutrition is not answered by extra grain, since severe acute malnutrition at weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations requires facility-based therapeutic care, and every outcome cited must carry its survey round, with under-five stunting recorded at 35.5 per cent in the fifth round of 2019-21 and 29.3 per cent in the sixth round of 2023-24. Why this earns marks: it explains a loop, attaches each lever to the exact link it cuts and ends with a treatment and data qualification.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 7 **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the cycle is intergenerational, so it is broken only at the points where deprivation becomes irreversible and where entitlement fails to travel with the person. Named evidence and example: the loop from income and asset deprivation through calorie and micronutrient deficit to impaired cognitive, physical and

immune development, low human capital and low earnings; the first thousand days from conception to age two; Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi layer under the Ministry of Women and Child Development; PM POSHAN in Classes I to VIII under the Ministry of Education; One Nation One Ration Card portability using Aadhaar-seeded cards and electronic point-of-sale machines; and the national anaemia strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design for adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women. Analysis: the first thousand days fix the sequencing, because a stunted child becomes a lower-earning adult whose child is again undernourished, so maternal and adolescent nutrition are child-nutrition instruments rather than separate heads; portability addresses the exclusion produced by migration; and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene addresses absorption, which no additional grain allocation can reach. Qualification: acute malnutrition is not answered by extra grain, since severe acute malnutrition at weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations requires facility-based therapeutic care, and every outcome cited must carry its survey round, with under-five stunting recorded at 35.5 per cent in the fifth round of 2019-21 and 29.3 per cent in the sixth round of 2023-24. Why this earns marks: it explains a loop, attaches each lever to the exact link it cuts and ends with a treatment and data qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 7”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain how poverty and malnutrition reinforce each other and identify the interventions that can break the cycle. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The loop is intergenerational and multi-causal, so the answer must trace deprivation through undernutrition, impaired development and low human capital back to low earnings, then attach named multi-sectoral levers rather than a single-scheme remedy.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for.
- The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.
- The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.
- Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public

distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

Qualified conclusion: The loop is intergenerational and multi-causal, so the answer must trace deprivation through undernutrition, impaired development and low human capital back to low earnings, then attach named multi-sectoral levers rather than a single-scheme remedy.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Explain how poverty and malnutrition reinforce each other and identify the interventions that...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The loop is intergenerational and multi-causal, so the answer must trace deprivation through undernutrition, impaired development and low human capital back to low earnings, then attach named multi-sectoral levers rather than a single-scheme remedy.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukt Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status,

denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The loop is intergenerational and multi-causal, so the answer must trace deprivation through undernutrition, impaired development and low human capital back to low earnings, then attach named multi-sectoral levers rather than a single-scheme remedy.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Explain how poverty and malnutrition reinforce each other and identify the interventions that...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Elucidate why measured poverty and measured hunger can move in different directions. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Different instruments measure different deprivations, so the answer must separate monetary poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry, then separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation to locate where the divergence is produced.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.
- Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.
- Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.
- The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that

indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

Qualified conclusion: Different instruments measure different deprivations, so the answer must separate monetary poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry, then separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation to locate where the divergence is produced.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Elucidate why measured poverty and measured hunger can move in different directions. Answer...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Different instruments measure different deprivations, so the answer must separate monetary poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry, then separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation to locate where the divergence is produced.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy,

portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Different instruments measure different deprivations, so the answer must separate monetary poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry, then separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation to locate where the divergence is produced.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Elucidate why measured poverty and measured hunger can move in different directions. Answer...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess whether India's food-security architecture has converted a discretionary scheme into an enforceable entitlement. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The statutory shift is real and is evidenced by the entitlement quantities, the life-cycle provisions and the food security allowance, but coverage identification, portability gaps and absorption failures limit it, so the assessment must be graded and must name the tier at which the claim fails.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.
- The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.
- The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

- The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

Qualified conclusion: The statutory shift is real and is evidenced by the entitlement quantities, the life-cycle provisions and the food security allowance, but coverage identification, portability gaps and absorption failures limit it, so the assessment must be graded and must name the tier at which the claim fails.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess whether India's food-security architecture has converted a discretionary scheme into...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The statutory shift is real and is evidenced by the entitlement quantities, the life-cycle provisions and the food security allowance, but coverage identification, portability gaps and absorption failures limit it, so the assessment must be graded and must name the tier at which the claim fails.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative

status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.

Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The statutory shift is real and is evidenced by the entitlement quantities, the life-cycle provisions and the food security allowance, but coverage identification, portability gaps and absorption failures limit it, so the assessment must be graded and must name the tier at which the claim fails.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess whether India's food-security architecture has converted a discretionary scheme into...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the claim that a focus on food availability rather than on human-development policy is the principal cause of hunger in India. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Availability is only the first of four stages, so the examination must test the claim against access, absorption and utilisation, concede what the availability argument does explain, and end by naming the conversion failures that grain allocation cannot reach.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.
- Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.
- The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One

Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.

- Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.

Qualified conclusion: Availability is only the first of four stages, so the examination must test the claim against access, absorption and utilisation, concede what the availability argument does explain, and end by naming the conversion failures that grain allocation cannot reach.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the claim that a focus on food availability rather than on human-development policy...", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Availability is only the first of four stages, so the examination must test the claim against access, absorption and utilisation, concede what the availability argument does explain, and end by naming the conversion failures that grain allocation cannot reach.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Availability is only the first of four stages, so the examination must test the claim against access, absorption and utilisation, concede what the availability argument does explain, and end by naming the conversion failures that grain allocation cannot reach.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the claim that a focus on food availability rather than on human-development policy...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the design of India's nutrition delivery system across the life cycle and the trade-offs it embodies. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The system layers a statutory grain entitlement, an anganwadi service layer and a school-meal layer across different ages and ministries, so the assessment must test each layer against the outcome it claims, name the ration-format and ministry trade-offs, and close with a graded verdict.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.
- PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.
- A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires

kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it.

- Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.

Qualified conclusion: The system layers a statutory grain entitlement, an anganwadi service layer and a school-meal layer across different ages and ministries, so the assessment must test each layer against the outcome it claims, name the ration-format and ministry trade-offs, and close with a graded verdict.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess the design of India's nutrition delivery system across the life cycle and the trade-...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The system layers a statutory grain entitlement, an anganwadi service layer and a school-meal layer across different ages and ministries, so the assessment must test each layer against the outcome it claims, name the ration-format and ministry trade-offs, and close with a graded verdict.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation

centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The system layers a statutory grain entitlement, an anganwadi service layer and a school-meal layer across different ages and ministries, so the assessment must test each layer against the outcome it claims, name the ration-format and ministry trade-offs, and close with a graded verdict.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess the design of India's nutrition delivery system across the life cycle and the trade-...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess whether portability and identification reform have reduced exclusion from India's food entitlement. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Portability addresses one exclusion mechanism while identification reform can generate another, so the assessment must separate inclusion from exclusion error, use the official identification process as evidence, and end with a verdict that carries a stated data limit.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.
- Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.
- The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana

households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

- The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

Qualified conclusion: Portability addresses one exclusion mechanism while identification reform can generate another, so the assessment must separate inclusion from exclusion error, use the official identification process as evidence, and end with a verdict that carries a stated data limit.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess whether portability and identification reform have reduced exclusion from India's food...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Portability addresses one exclusion mechanism while identification reform can generate another, so the assessment must separate inclusion from exclusion error, use the official identification process as evidence, and end with a verdict that carries a stated data limit.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal,

read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Portability addresses one exclusion mechanism while identification reform can generate another, so the assessment must separate inclusion from exclusion error, use the official identification process as evidence, and end with a verdict that carries a stated data limit.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

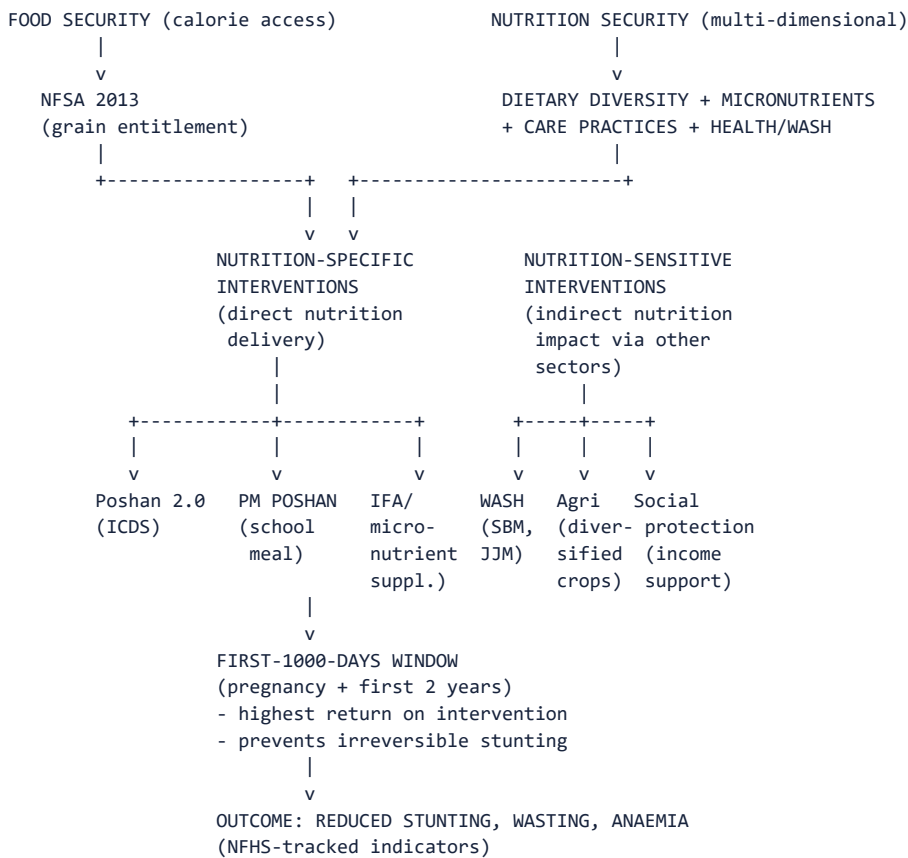
Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess whether portability and identification reform have reduced exclusion from India's food...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Social Justice | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-II; GS-III (food security economics), GS-I (population/poverty geography). **Core area:** NFSA implementation gaps; Poshan 2.0 architecture; nutrition-sensitive vs nutrition-specific interventions; ONORC mechanics; NFHS data interpretation. **Grounded in:** NFSA, 2013; PMGKAY-NFSA merger and free-foodgrain policy (1 Jan 2023, extended to Dec 2028); Poshan 2.0 guidelines (MWCD); PM POSHAN (MoE); NFHS-6 (2023-24), released 29 May 2026, with NFHS-5 as comparator; 2024 GS-II PYQ Q7. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* basic/02_Poverty-Hunger-Food-and-Nutrition-Security.md.

1. Architecture



Analytical claim: ANALYSIS: Breaking the poverty-malnutrition-human-capital cycle (2024 Q7) requires both nutrition-specific interventions (Poshan 2.0, PM POSHAN, micronutrient supplementation) and nutrition-sensitive convergence (WASH, income support, agricultural diversification); NFSA grain entitlements address calorie access but not dietary diversity or the first-1000-days critical window.

2. Concepts and distinctions

Concept	Precise meaning
FACT: Nutrition-specific interventions	Directly target nutritional outcomes - e.g., supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring, breastfeeding promotion (Poshan 2.0, PM POSHAN).
FACT: Nutrition-sensitive interventions	Address underlying determinants of nutrition through other sectors - e.g., sanitation/water (WASH), agriculture diversification, social protection, women's education - impact nutrition indirectly.
FACT: First-1000-days (conception to age 2)	The critical window during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment; interventions here yield the highest return.
ANALYSIS: Inclusion error vs exclusion error (in NFSA)	Inclusion error: non-eligible persons on PDS lists (leakage); exclusion error: eligible persons excluded (often due to documentation/Aadhaar issues) - ONORC and deduplication aim to reduce both, but exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists.
ANALYSIS: Take-home ration (THR) vs hot cooked meal (HCM)	THR: dry rations given to beneficiaries to cook at home (used for PLW, children 6 months-3 years); HCM: cooked meal served at anganwadi/school - HCM ensures consumption at point of delivery but requires infrastructure; THR is more flexible but may be diverted within households.
FACT: Severe Acute Malnutrition (SAM) vs Moderate Acute Malnutrition (MAM)	SAM: weight-for-height < -3 SD (severe wasting), requires facility-based therapeutic care; MAM: weight-for-height < -2 SD to -3 SD, can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding - both tracked by ICDS/anganwadi growth monitoring.

3. Detailed causal chain: the intergenerational trap (2024 PYQ Q7)

1. **Poverty** limits household capacity to purchase diverse, nutrient-dense food and invest in health/sanitation.
2. **Food insecurity** manifests as calorie deficit (hunger) and dietary monotony (lack of micronutrients).
3. **Undernutrition in early childhood** (especially first 1000 days) causes stunting (chronic) and wasting (acute), impairs cognitive development and weakens immunity.
4. **Impaired development** reduces school attendance, learning outcomes and skill acquisition.
5. **Low human capital** translates into low productivity and earnings in adulthood.
6. **Low earnings** perpetuate household poverty, which is then transmitted to the next generation (intergenerational trap).
7. **Breaking-the-cycle levers:**
 - Nutrition-specific: Poshan 2.0 (first-1000-days focus), PM POSHAN (school-age), micronutrient supplementation (IFA tablets).
 - Nutrition-sensitive: WASH convergence (SBM, JJM), income support (DBT, social security), agricultural diversification.
 - Portability: ONORC for migrant-worker inclusion.

4. Institutional and reform architecture

- FACT: **NFSA, 2013**: Statutory entitlement; state-wise identification of priority

households and AAY; coverage ratio (~67% of population) but exclusion errors persist for migrants, homeless and those lacking documentation.

- **FACT: Poshan 2.0 / Saksham Anganwadi (MWCD):** Consolidates ICDS, Poshan Abhiyaan and related schemes; emphasises convergence, Jan Andolan (community mobilisation), ICT-enabled monitoring (Poshan Tracker app) and first-1000-days targeting.

- **FACT: PM POSHAN (MoE):** Centrally-sponsored scheme with cost-sharing between Centre and states; norms for calorie/protein content, mid-day meal menus, kitchen infrastructure and social audit.

- **FACT: ONORC:** Requires Aadhaar seeding of ration cards, ePoS deployment at fair-price shops and inter-state data exchange via IMPDS portal; operational across all 36 states/UTs since Assam completed the pan-India rollout in June 2022.

- **ANALYSIS: Poshan Tracker (app):** Real-time data entry by anganwadi workers for growth monitoring, supplementary nutrition delivery and service coverage - but data quality depends on AWW capacity and device availability.

5. Indian applications and boundary cases

- **FACT: 2024 GS-II PYQ Q7:** The question directly tests the vicious-cycle concept and expects multi-sectoral levers; a narrow NFSA-only answer misses the nutrition-security dimension.

- **ANALYSIS: ONORC during COVID-19 lockdowns:** Enabled migrant workers stranded outside home states to access rations - demonstrated portability value but also exposed exclusion of those without Aadhaar seeding.

- **ANALYSIS: NFHS-5 inter-state variation:** States like Kerala and Tamil Nadu have low stunting; states like Bihar and UP have high stunting - illustrates that NFSA coverage alone does not explain nutrition outcomes; health infrastructure, WASH and women's education matter.

- **ANALYSIS: Boundary case - fortified rice under NFSA:** Government has mandated distribution of fortified rice (iron, folic acid, B12) through PDS - a nutrition-specific enhancement within the food-security architecture, but effectiveness depends on consumption patterns and bioavailability.

6. Limitations and trade-offs

- **ANALYSIS: NFSA grain-centricity:** Subsidised rice/wheat addresses calorie access but not dietary diversity (pulses, vegetables, fruits, animal-source foods) - nutrition security requires complementary measures.

- **ANALYSIS: Exclusion error vs portability:** ONORC addresses migrant exclusion but requires Aadhaar seeding and ePoS connectivity; beneficiaries without documentation or in remote areas may still be excluded.

- **ANALYSIS: Anganwadi workforce capacity:** Poshan 2.0 relies on AWWs/helpers for growth monitoring, counselling and supplementary nutrition delivery; low honoraria, multi-tasking and vacancies affect service quality.

- **ANALYSIS: Data lag:** NFHS rounds are periodic (every 4-5 years); administrative dashboards (Poshan Tracker) provide high-frequency data but may suffer from reporting bias - the "outcome-learning gap" noted in 00_Master-Framework.md.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- **FACT:** Poshan 2.0 emphasises the "first 1000 days" (conception to age 2) as the critical window for preventing stunting and cognitive impairment.

- **FACT:** NFSA coverage: ~75% rural, ~50% urban populations are entitled to foodgrains; the Act's statutory Central Issue Price ceiling is rice Rs 3/kg, wheat Rs 2/kg, coarse grains Rs 1/kg, but current policy is free distribution (since 1 Jan 2023, extended to Dec 2028).

- **FACT:** PM POSHAN (erstwhile Mid-Day Meal) targets children in government and

government-aided schools, Classes I-VIII.

- FACT: ONORC enables ration-card portability via Aadhaar seeding and ePoS; tracked on the IMPDS portal.

- FACT: SAM (Severe Acute Malnutrition): weight-for-height < -3 SD; requires facility-based therapeutic care (Nutrition Rehabilitation Centres).

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: Poshan 2.0 is administered by the Ministry of Education. -> Poshan 2.0 is administered by MWCD; PM POSHAN is administered by the Ministry of Education.

- WRONG: NFSA provides universal coverage to all citizens. -> NFSA covers ~67% of the population (priority households + AAY) via state-wise identification, not universal coverage.

- WRONG: NFSA beneficiaries currently pay the Act's statutory Central Issue Prices (Rs 3/kg rice, Rs 2/kg wheat, Rs 1/kg coarse grains). -> Those prices remain the statutory ceiling in the Act, but since 1 January 2023 the PMGKAY-NFSA merger has made NFSA foodgrains free of cost for AAY/priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended through December 2028.

9. CURRENT: Current-anchor note

- CURRENT: **Survey-status check (29 May 2026):** NFHS-6 (2023-24) is released; reported under-five stunting is 29.3%, against 35.5% in NFHS-5. Retain each survey round and do not splice indicators from different rounds into one baseline.

- CURRENT: **Free-foodgrain policy:** NFSA foodgrains have been distributed free of cost to AAY/priority-household beneficiaries since 1 January 2023 (PMGKAY merged into NFSA, replacing the earlier Rs 1-3/kg Central Issue Price payment), and the Union Cabinet extended this free-distribution policy for five years, through December 2028, at an approved outlay of roughly Rs 11.8 lakh crore covering roughly 81 crore beneficiaries.

- CURRENT: Fortified rice distribution under NFSA was mandated for phased national rollout; the durable policy fact is the government's fortification mandate, not a specific coverage percentage that changes as rollout progresses.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: **2024 Q7 (10 marks):** A strong answer should:

1. Diagram the vicious cycle (poverty -> undernutrition -> impaired development -> low productivity -> poverty).

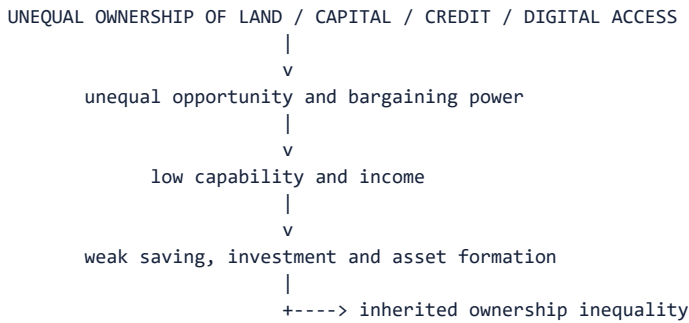
2. Distinguish nutrition-specific (Poshan 2.0, PM POSHAN, micronutrient supplementation) from nutrition-sensitive (WASH, income support, agriculture) interventions.

3. Emphasise the first-1000-days window and women's nutrition (anaemia in adolescent girls and PLW).

4. Cite ONORC portability for migrant inclusion.

5. Conclude with the convergence imperative: no single scheme breaks the cycle.

- FACT: **2025 GS-II Q16 (15 marks, 250 words):** Build the "paradox of poverty" as a self-reinforcing asset-capability loop:



Separate productive-asset reform (land records/tenancy security, credit, skills, commons and digital access) from necessary but non-transformative consumption relief.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: The poverty-malnutrition-human-capital cycle is intergenerational and multi-causal; breaking it requires nutrition-specific interventions (Poshan 2.0 for the first 1000 days, PM POSHAN for school-age, micronutrient supplementation) combined with nutrition-sensitive convergence (WASH, income support, agricultural diversification) and portability for migrants (ONORC) - NFSA grain entitlements are necessary but not sufficient.

1. Define the vicious cycle with the intergenerational-trap logic.
2. Distinguish food security (calorie access) from nutrition security (dietary diversity, micronutrients, care, WASH).
3. Map nutrition-specific vs nutrition-sensitive interventions.
4. Identify the first-1000-days window as the highest-return intervention point.
5. Acknowledge implementation gaps (exclusion error, AWW capacity, data lag).
6. Recommend convergence with a specific, measurable outcome target (e.g., reduce stunting by X percentage points in Y years via coordinated Poshan 2.0 - SBM + JJM action).

12. Probable questions

- FACT: **Mains (10 marks, 2024 Q7):** Poverty and malnutrition create a vicious cycle, adversely affecting human capital formation. What steps can be taken to break the cycle?
- FACT: **Mains (15 marks, 2025 GS-II Q16):** "Inequality in the ownership pattern of resources is one of the major causes of poverty. Discuss in the context of 'paradox of poverty'."
- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Which of the following is administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development - PM POSHAN, Poshan 2.0, ONORC or NFSA?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Distinguish nutrition-specific from nutrition-sensitive interventions. How does India's policy architecture attempt to integrate both for improved nutritional outcomes?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** "ONORC is a necessary but not sufficient condition for ensuring food and nutrition security for migrant workers." Discuss.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: [basic/02_Poverty-Hunger-Food-and-Nutrition-Security.md](#).
- FACT: Economy/[basic/12_MSP-Procurement-Buffer-Stocks-PDS-and-Food-Security.md](#) - procurement/buffer-stock mechanics.
- FACT: Governance/[basic/13_Public-Finance-and-Service-Delivery-Tools.md](#) - DBT/JAM for transfers and Aadhaar-seeding mechanics.
- FACT: [01_Social-Justice-Concept-Inclusion-and-Welfare-State-Framework.md](#) - the capability approach: nutrition inputs must convert into health/cognitive capability.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	17	Food availability focus against human development policies as cause of hunger	How far do you agree · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	GS-II	7	Divergence between poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure	Elucidate · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic; word limit taken from the instruction block	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Food availability focus against human development policies as cause of hunger
- Divergence between poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Poverty, Hunger, Food and Nutrition Security: RAPID RIGHT, SCHEME AND MEASURED-OUTCOME MAP

- What this owner holds and the demands routed to it:** This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion.
- The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle:** The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for.
- Food security against nutrition security:** Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

4. **Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators:** Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.
5. **The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013:** The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.
6. **Central Issue Price ceiling against the free-distribution policy:** The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic.
7. **The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act:** The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.
8. **The food security allowance as the statutory remedy:** The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.
9. **The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act:** The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.
10. **Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism:** One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

11. **Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer:** Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.
12. **PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer:** PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.
13. **The first thousand days as the critical window:** The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.
14. **Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions:** Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.
15. **Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal:** A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it.
16. **Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path:** Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.
17. **Measured outcomes with their survey round attached:** The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.
18. **The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence:** Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems,

access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

19. **The intervention bank for breaking the cycle:** The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.
20. **Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership:** Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

Poverty, Hunger, Food and Nutrition Security: CLOSE-OPTION AND ENTITLEMENT TRAPS

- Do not treat the statutory foodgrain entitlement as a comprehensive nutrition instrument, because it addresses calorie and grain access while nutrition security requires diversity, micronutrients, care practices and sanitation.
- Do not state the Central Issue Price ceiling of three, two and one rupee per kilogram as the price currently paid, because foodgrains have been distributed free of cost to beneficiaries since 1 January 2023 under the merger extended through December 2028.
- Do not describe the Act as universal, because it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural and fifty per cent of the urban population through State-level identification.
- Do not use stunting and wasting interchangeably, because one is height-for-age and chronic while the other is weight-for-height and acute.
- Do not attribute PM POSHAN to the Ministry of Women and Child Development, because PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education while Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development.
- Do not describe One Nation One Ration Card as a separate ration card or a separate entitlement, because it is a portability and interoperability feature for existing beneficiaries.
- Do not quote a portability transaction count, because the cumulative figure on the integrated portal rises continuously and the durable fact is operational inter-State portability.
- Do not combine indicators from the fifth and sixth rounds of the National Family Health Survey without naming each round and its years.
- Do not present a fall in monetary poverty as proof that hunger has fallen, because monetary poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations.
- Do not answer an acute-malnutrition question with an additional grain allocation, because severe acute malnutrition requires screening, referral and facility-based therapeutic care.
- Do not treat the take-home ration and the hot cooked meal as equivalent, because one guarantees consumption at the point of delivery while the other can be redistributed within the household.
- Do not attribute a delivery failure to the government in general, because the Act divides allocation and transport at the Centre from identification, card issue and distribution in the States and Union Territories.
- Do not claim that fortification can substitute for dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.
- Do not omit the food security allowance and the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015 when arguing that the entitlement is a rights-based claim, because that clause is the remedy.

- Do not invent a coverage count, a beneficiary total, a nutrition indicator, a survey round, a budget number or an official answer key for this topic, and do not record an option for a routed objective demand whose official key the ledgers report as unavailable locally.

Poverty, Hunger, Food and Nutrition Security: ANSWER-WRITING SPINE

NAME THE DEPRIVATION OR CLAIM -> IDENTIFY THE RIGHT-HOLDER AND THE DUTY-BEARER
 -> SEPARATE THE CONSTITUTIONAL OR STATUTORY ENTITLEMENT FROM THE SCHEME THAT CARRIES IT
 -> TRACE ADMINISTRATIVE DELIVERY: IDENTIFICATION, ENROLMENT, ACCESS, QUALITY
 -> TEST THE MEASURED OUTCOME AGAINST THE INPUT, NAMING SURVEY, ROUND AND YEAR
 -> SEPARATE INCLUSION ERROR FROM EXCLUSION ERROR AND COVERAGE FROM CAPABILITY
 -> CLOSE WITH A GRADED VERDICT AND AN EXPLICIT INDICATOR OR STATUS CAVEAT

Poverty, Hunger, Food and Nutrition Security: DATED-INDICATOR AND STATUS BOUNDARY

One live official source was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's National Food Security Act portal page was read successfully on that date and states that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013 and marks a paradigm shift in the approach to food security from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system so that about two-thirds of the population is covered, that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards, that the Act is implemented in all States and Union Territories and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present with identification treated as a continuous process of excluding ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and of including births and genuine left-out households, that a guiding principle is the life-cycle approach under which pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years are entitled to a nutritious meal free of cost through anganwadi centres under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme with higher nutritional norms for malnourished children up to six years, that pregnant women and lactating mothers are further entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees, that on non-supply of entitled quantities the entitled person may receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015, and that responsibility is joint, with the Centre allocating and transporting foodgrains to designated depots and assisting delivery to the fair-price shop doorstep while States and Union Territories identify eligible households, issue ration cards and distribute entitlements. Only those statements of statutory design, coverage and responsibility are used from that page. The remaining dated elements are those already carried by the repository owners with their status checks, namely the statutory Central Issue Price ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two for wheat and one for coarse grains, the merger of the welfare grain scheme into the Act from 1 January 2023 making foodgrains free of cost to Antyodaya and priority households, the Union Cabinet extension of free distribution for five years through December 2028, the administration of Poshan 2.0 by the Ministry of Women and Child Development and of PM POSHAN by the Ministry of Education, and the National Family Health Survey values of 35.5 per cent under-five stunting, 19.3 per cent wasting and 67.1 per cent child anaemia in the fifth round of 2019-21 against 29.3 per cent under-five stunting in the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026 and covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households. Every one of those values is round-specific or policy-date-specific and is cited here with that status, and the package states expressly that rounds must never be merged and that a portability transaction count is not asserted because it rises continuously. No poverty headcount, no multidimensional poverty value, no Periodic Labour Force Survey or National Sample Survey figure, no NITI Aayog or Sustainable Development Goal score, no budget or subsidy number, no scheme eligibility rule beyond the Act's own recorded coverage rule and no official answer key is asserted or inferred anywhere in this package.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Vicious cycle

POVERTY -> income and asset deprivation restricts the household food basket
-> FOOD INSECURITY: calorie deficit plus protein and micronutrient deficit
-> IMPAIRED DEVELOPMENT: cognitive, physical and immune capacity fall
-> LOW HUMAN CAPITAL: schooling attainment and productivity fall
-> LOW EARNINGS: the deprivation is transmitted to the next generation
MUST REMEMBER: Poverty, hunger, food insecurity, undernutrition and malnutrition overlap...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Security types

FOOD SECURITY -> reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food
CARRIED BY -> statutory foodgrain entitlement; a calorie and grain-access instrument
NUTRITION SECURITY -> dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices, sanitation
CONSEQUENCE -> the distribution system can work while nutrition outcomes stagnate

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Indicator card

STUNTING -> low height-for-age under five; chronic cumulative deprivation
WASTING -> low weight-for-height under five; recent or acute shortage or illness
ANAEMIA -> haemoglobin deficiency from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall
SAM -> weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations; therapeutic care
MAM -> minus two to minus three standard deviations; community supplementary feeding

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Statutory entitlement card

ENACTED -> 5 July 2013; a shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach
QUANTUM -> 5 kg per person per month priority; 35 kg per household per month Antyodaya
COVERAGE RULE -> up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population
OFFICIAL COUNT -> maximum coverage 81.34 crore persons; about 80 crore covered at present
HEAD OF HOUSEHOLD -> eldest woman aged 18 or above for issue of the ration card

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Price discipline card

STATUTORY CEILING -> rice 3 rupees, wheat 2 rupees, coarse grains 1 rupee per kilogram
CURRENT POLICY -> free of cost to Antyodaya and priority households since 1 January 2023
AUTHORITY -> the welfare grain scheme was merged into the Act on that date
EXTENSION -> the Union Cabinet extended free distribution for five years to December 2028
RULE -> never state the ceiling as the price a beneficiary currently pays

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Life-cycle provisions

PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN -> nutritious meal free of cost; maternity benefit
MATERNITY BENEFIT -> not less than 6000 rupees to partly compensate wage loss
CHILDREN 6 MONTHS TO 14 YEARS -> meal through anganwadi centres and through schools
MALNOURISHED UNDER SIX -> higher nutritional norms are prescribed

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Remedy and responsibility

NON-SUPPLY -> the entitled person may claim a food security allowance from the State
GOVERNED BY -> the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015
CENTRE -> allocation, transport to depots and assistance to the fair-price shop doorstep
STATES -> identification, ration cards and distribution of the entitlement
USE -> attribute a delivery failure to a named tier, never to government in general

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Service layers by age

POSHAN 2.0 -> Ministry of Women and Child Development; anganwadi centres
ITS SERVICES -> supplementary nutrition, growth monitoring, pre-school, referral
PM POSHAN -> Ministry of Education; cooked meal in Classes I to VIII
ITS OBJECTIVES -> attendance, retention and improved nutritional status
TRAP -> the ministry pairing is reversed in close-option questions

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Ration format trade-off

TAKE-HOME RATION -> dry ration cooked at home; pregnant and lactating women
ALSO FOR -> children between six months and three years
HOT COOKED MEAL -> served at the anganwadi centre or the school
GAIN -> the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery
COST -> it needs kitchen and staffing infrastructure; dry ration may be redistributed

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Portability mechanism

PROBLEM -> a migrant is listed on a State-specific roll and loses access on moving
-> MECHANISM: Aadhaar-seeded ration card read at an electronic point-of-sale machine
-> EFFECT: the existing entitlement is drawn at any enabled fair-price shop
LIMIT -> it is not a separate card and not a separate entitlement
CLAIM LIMIT -> the cumulative transaction count rises continuously and is not fixed here
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Poverty incidence is not depth, food availability is not household...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Convergence bank

NUTRITION-SPECIFIC -> feeding, micronutrients, growth monitoring, breastfeeding support
NUTRITION-SENSITIVE -> water and sanitation, agriculture, social protection, girls schooling
ANAEMIA -> the national anaemia strategy uses a six-by-six-by-six intervention design
FORTIFICATION -> reaches selected micronutrient gaps at scale
LIMIT -> it cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or treatment
EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use NFSA, PDS/ONORC, ICDS/Saksham Anganwadi,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Dated outcome and answer spine

ROUND FIVE 2019-21 -> stunting 35.5, wasting 19.3, child anaemia 67.1 per cent
ROUND SIX 2023-24 -> under-five stunting 29.3 per cent; released 29 May 2026
SCOPE -> round six covered 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households
RULE -> name the round beside every value and never merge two rounds
CLOSE -> availability, access, absorption and utilisation, then a graded verdict